Al-Fawaid

“The Benefits”

Ibn al-Qayyim al-Jawziyya

(d. 751 AH / 1350 CE)

Learner-friendly translation for Arabic language students
Dar al-Kutub al-Ilmiyya edition, Beirut

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قاعدة جليلة إذا أردت الانتفاع بالقرآن فاجمع قلبك عند تلاوته وسماعه

[A] Great Principle: If You Want to Benefit from the Quran, Then Gather Your Heart During Its Recitation and Hearing [It]

بِسم الله الرَّحْمَن الرَّحِيم

In the name of God, the Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate.

قَالَ الشَّيْخ مُحي الدّين السنّة قامع الْبِدْعَة أَبُو عبد الله الشهير بِابْن قيّم الجوزيّة رحمه الله ورضى عَنهُ

The Sheikh, reviver of the religion [and] the Sunnah, suppressor of innovation, Abu Abdullah, known as Ibn Qayyim al-Jawziyya — may God have mercy on him and [be] pleased with him — said:

إِذا أردْت الِانْتِفَاع بِالْقُرْآنِ فاجمع قَلْبك عِنْد تِلَاوَته وسماعه

If you want to benefit from the Quran, then gather your heart during its recitation and hearing [it],

وألْقِ سَمعك واحضر حُضُور من يخاطبه بِهِ من تكلّم بِهِ سُبْحَانَهُ مِنْهُ إِلَيْهِ

and direct your hearing, and be present [with] the presence of one whom the One who spoke it — glorified [is] He — addresses with it, from Him to him.

فانه خَاطب مِنْهُ لَك على لِسَان رَسُوله

For it [is] an address from Him to you upon the tongue of His messenger.

قَالَ تَعَالَى

[God] Most High said:

﴿إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَذِكْرَىٰ لِمَن كَانَ لَهُ قَلْبٌ أَوْ أَلْقَى السَّمْعَ وَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ﴾

Indeed in that [is] surely [a] reminder for whoever [there] was for him [a] heart, or [he] directed [his] hearing while he [is] [a] witness.

Sahih Intl: Indeed in that is a reminder for whoever has a heart or who listens while he is present [in mind] — [50:37].

وَذَلِكَ أَن تَمام التَّأْثِير لمّا كَانَ مَوْقُوفا على مُؤثر مُقْتَض

And that [is] because the completeness of the effect, since it was dependent on [a] necessary effective cause,

وَمحل قَابل وَشرط لحُصُول الْأَثر وَانْتِفَاء الْمَانِع الَّذِي يمْنَع مِنْهُ

and [a] receiving place, and [a] condition for the occurrence of the effect, and the absence of the obstacle that prevents it —

تضمّنت الْآيَة بَيَان ذَلِك كلّه بأوجز لفظ وأبينه وأدلّه على المُرَاد

the verse contained the explanation of all of that in the most concise wording, the clearest of it, and the most indicative of the intended [meaning].

فَقَوله ﴿إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لذكرى﴾ اشار إِلَى مَا تقدّم من أوّل السُّورَة الى هَهُنَا

So His saying ﴿Indeed in that [is] surely [a] reminder﴾ pointed to what preceded from the beginning of the surah to here.

وَهَذَا هُوَ المؤثّر

And this — it [is] the effective cause.

وَقَوله ﴿لِمَنْ كَانَ لَهُ قَلْبٌ﴾ فَهَذَا هُوَ الْمحل الْقَابِل

And His saying ﴿for whoever [there] was for him [a] heart﴾ — so this — it [is] the receiving place.

وَالْمرَاد بِهِ الْقلب الحيّ الَّذِي يعقل عَن الله

And what [is] meant by it [is] the living heart that understands from God,

كَمَا قَالَ تَعَالَى

as [God] Most High said:

﴿إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ وَقُرْآنٌ مُبِينٌ﴾

It [is] nothing but [a] remembrance and [a] clear Quran,

Sahih Intl: And We did not give Prophet Muhammad, knowledge of poetry, nor is it befitting for him. It is not but a message and a clear Qur'an — [36:69]

﴿لِيُنْذِرَ مَنْ كَانَ حَيًّا﴾

to warn whoever was alive.

[36:70]

أَي حيّ الْقلب

Meaning: alive of heart.

وَقَوله ﴿أَوْ أَلْقَى السَّمْعَ﴾ أَي وجَّه سَمعه وأصغى حاسّة سَمعه إِلَى مَا يُقَال لَهُ

And His saying ﴿or directed [his] hearing﴾ — meaning: he directed his hearing and inclined his sense of hearing to what [is] said to him.

وَهَذَا شَرط التأثّر بالْكَلَام

And this [is] the condition for being affected by the speech.

وَقَوله ﴿وَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ﴾ أَي شَاهد الْقلب حَاضر غير غَائِب

And His saying ﴿while he [is] [a] witness﴾ — meaning: [the] heart [is] witnessing, present, not absent.

قَالَ ابْن قُتَيْبَة اسْتمع كتاب الله وَهُوَ شَاهد الْقلب والفهم لَيْسَ بغافل وَلَا ساه

Ibn Qutaybah said: [He] listened to the Book of God while he [is] present of heart and understanding, not heedless and not inattentive.

وَهُوَ إِشَارَة إِلَى الْمَانِع من حُصُول التَّأْثِير

And it [is] [a] reference to the obstacle [preventing] the occurrence of the effect,

وَهُوَ سَهْو الْقلب وغيبته عَن تعقّل مَا يُقَال لَهُ وَالنَّظَر فِيهِ وتأمّله

and it [is] the heart's neglect and its absence from understanding what [is] said to it, and looking into it, and contemplating it.

فَإِذا حصل الْمُؤثر وَهُوَ الْقُرْآن وَالْمحل الْقَابِل وَهُوَ الْقلب الْحَيّ

So when the effective cause [is] present — and it [is] the Quran — and the receiving place — and it [is] the living heart —

وَوجد الشَّرْط وَهُوَ الإصغاء وانتفى الْمَانِع

and the condition [is] found — and it [is] attentive listening — and the obstacle [is] removed —

وَهُوَ اشْتِغَال الْقلب وذهوله عَن معنى الْخطاب وانصرافه عَنهُ إِلَى شَيْء آخر

and it [is] the heart's distraction and its drifting from the meaning of the address, and its turning away from it to something else —

حصل الْأَثر وَهُوَ الِانْتِفَاع والتذكّر

the effect occurred, and it [is] benefit and remembering.
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فَإِن قيل إِذا كَانَ التَّأْثِير إِنَّمَا يتم بِمَجْمُوع هَذِه فَمَا وَجه دُخُول أَدَاة أَو فِي قَوْله

If it [is] said: if the effect [is] only completed by the combination of all these, then what [is] the reason for the use of the particle “or” in His saying:

﴿أَوْ أَلْقَى السَّمْعَ﴾

“or [he] cast [his] hearing”

[50:37]

والموضع مَوضِع وَاو الْجمع لَا مَوضِع أَو الَّتِي هِيَ لأحد الشَّيْئَيْنِ

when the place [is] [a] place for the “and” of joining, not [a] place for “or” which [is] for one of two things?

قيل هَذَا سُؤال جيّد وَالْجَوَاب عَنهُ أَن يُقَال

It [is] said: this [is] [a] good question, and the answer to it [is] that it [is] said:

خرج الْكَلَام بِأَو بِاعْتِبَار حَال الْمُخَاطب الْمَدْعُو

the speech came with “or” in consideration of the condition of the one addressed [and] called.

فَإِن من النَّاس من يكون حَيّ الْقلب واعيه تَامّ الْفطْرَة

For among people [is he] who has [a] living heart, aware, complete in inborn nature.

فَإِذا فكّر بِقَلْبِه وجال بفكره دلّه قلبه وعقله على صحّة الْقُرْآن وَأَنه الْحق

So when he reflects with his heart and roams with his thought, his heart and mind guide him to the soundness of the Quran and that it [is] the truth.

وَشهد قلبه بِمَا أخبر بِهِ الْقُرْآن

And his heart testifies to what the Quran informed of.

فَكَانَ وُرُود الْقُرْآن على قلبه نورا على نور الْفطْرَة

So the arrival of the Quran upon his heart was [a] light upon the light of inborn nature.

وَهَذَا وصف الَّذين قيل فيهم

And this [is] the description of those about whom it was said:

﴿وَيَرَى الَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْعِلْمَ الَّذِي أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْكَ مِنْ رَبِّكَ هُوَ الْحق﴾

“And those who were given knowledge see that what was sent down to you from your Lord — it [is] the truth.”

[34:6] Sahih Intl: And those who have been given knowledge see that what is revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, and it guides to the path of the Exalted in Might, the Praiseworthy.

وَقَالَ فِي حقّهم

And He said regarding them:

﴿اللَّهُ نُورُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ مَثَلُ نُورِهِ كَمِشْكَاةٍ فِيهَا مِصْبَاحٌ الْمِصْبَاحُ فِي زُجَاجَةٍ الزُّجَاجَةُ كَأَنَّهَا كَوْكَبٌ دُرِّيٌّ﴾

“God [is] the light of the heavens and the earth. The example of His light [is] like [a] niche in which [there is] [a] lamp. The lamp [is] in [a] glass. The glass [is] as if it [were] [a] shining star,

Sahih Intl: Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth. The example of His light is like a niche within which is a lamp, the lamp is within — [24:35]
glass, the glass as if it were a pearly [white] star lit from [the oil of] a blessed olive tree, neither of the east nor of the west, whose oil would almost glow
even if untouched by fire. Light upon light. Allah guides to His light whom He wills. And Allah presents examples for the people, and Allah is Knowing of
.all things

﴿يُوقَدُ مِنْ شَجَرَةٍ مُبَارَكَةٍ زَيْتُونَةٍ لَا شَرْقِيَّةٍ وَلا غَرْبِيَّةٍ يَكَادُ زَيْتُهَا يُضِيءُ وَلَوْ لَمْ تَمْسَسْهُ نَارٌ﴾

lit from [a] blessed tree — an olive, neither eastern nor western — its oil almost glows even if no fire touched it.

[24:35]

﴿نُورٌ عَلَى نُورٍ يَهْدِي اللَّهُ لِنُورِهِ مَنْ يَشَاءُ﴾

Light upon light. God guides to His light whom He wills."

[24:35]

فَهَذَا نور الْفطْرَة على نور الْوَحْي

So this [is] the light of inborn nature upon the light of revelation.

وَهَذَا حَال صَاحب الْقلب الْحَيّ الواعي

And this [is] the condition of the one with the living, aware heart.

قَالَ ابْن الْقيم وَقد ذكرنَا مَا تضمّنت هَذِه الْآيَة من الْأَسْرَار والعبر فِي كتاب اجْتِمَاع الجيوش الإسلامية على غَزْو المعطّلة والجهميّة

Ibn al-Qayyim said: we have mentioned what this verse contains of secrets and lessons in the book "The Gathering of the Islamic Armies for the Campaign Against the Deniers and the Jahmiyyah."

فَصَاحب الْقلب يجمع بَين قلبه وَبَين مَعَاني الْقُرْآن فيجدها كَأَنَّهَا قد كتبت فِيهِ

So the one with [a] heart gathers between his heart and the meanings of the Quran, and he finds them as if they were written in it.

فَهُوَ يَقْرَأها عَن ظَهْر قَلْب

So he reads them by heart.

وَمن النَّاس من لَا يكون تامَّ الاستعداد واعي الْقلب كَامِل الْحَيَاة

And among people [is he] who [is] not complete in readiness, nor aware of heart, nor fully alive.

فَيحْتَاج إِلَى شَاهد يميّز لَهُ بَين الْحق وَالْبَاطِل

So he needs [a] witness to distinguish for him between the truth and falsehood.

وَلم تبلغ حَيَاة قلبه ونوره وزكاء فطرته مبلغ صَاحب الْقلب الْحَيّ الواعي

And the life of his heart, its light, and the purity of his inborn nature have not reached the level of the one with the living, aware heart.

فطريق حُصُول هدايته أَن يفرغ سَمعه للْكَلَام وَقَلبه لتأمله والتفكير فِيهِ وتعقل مَعَانِيه

So the way to gain his guidance [is] that he empties his hearing for the speech, and his heart for reflecting on it, thinking about it, and understanding its meanings.

فَيعلم حِينَئِذٍ أَنه الْحق

Then he knows at that point that it [is] the truth.

فَالْأول حَال من رأى بِعَيْنِه مَا دعِي إِلَيْهِ وَأخْبر بِهِ

So the first [is] the condition of one who saw with his own eye what he was called to and informed about.

وَالثَّانِي حَال من علم صدق الْمخبر وتيقّنه وَقَالَ يَكْفِينِي خَبره

And the second [is] the condition of one who knew the truthfulness of the informer and was certain of it, and said: “His report [is] enough for me.”

فَهُوَ فِي مقَام الْإِيمَان والأوّل فِي مقَام الْإِحْسَان

So he [is] in the station of faith, and the first [is] in the station of excellence.

هَذَا قد وصل إِلَى علم الْيَقِين وترقى قلبه مِنْهُ إِلَى منزلة عين الْيَقِين

This one has reached the knowledge of certainty, and his heart rose from it to the level of the eye of certainty.

وَذَاكَ مَعَه التَّصْدِيق الْجَازِم الَّذِي خرج بِهِ من الْكفْر وَدخل بِهِ فِي الْإِسْلَام

And that one has with him the firm belief by which he left disbelief and entered Islam.

فعين الْيَقِين نَوْعَانِ نوع فِي الدُّنْيَا وَنَوع فِي الْآخِرَة

So the eye of certainty [is] two types: [a] type in this world, and [a] type in the Hereafter.

فَالْحَاصِل فِي الدُّنْيَا نسبته إِلَى الْقلب كنسبة الشَّاهِد

The one attained in this world — its relation to the heart [is] like the relation of the witness

فصل وقد جمعت هذه السورة من أصول الإيمان ما يكفي ويشفي ويغني عن

Section: This surah has gathered from the foundations of faith what suffices, heals, and frees [one] from

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إِلَى الْعين وَمَا أخْبرت بِهِ الرُّسُل من الْغَيْب يعاين فِي الْآخِرَة بالأبصار

to the eye. And what the messengers informed of from the unseen [will be] seen in the Hereafter with [the] eyes,

وَفِي الدُّنْيَا بالبصائر

and in this world with [the] inner sight.

فَهُوَ عين يَقِين فِي المرتبتين

So it [is] the essence of certainty in both levels.

فَإِنَّهَا تضمّنت تَقْرِير المبدأ والمعاد والتوحيد والنبوّة وَالْإِيمَان بِالْمَلَائِكَةِ

For it contained the establishment of the Origin, the Return, monotheism, prophethood, and faith in the angels,

وانقسام النَّاس إِلَى هَالك شقي وفائز سعيد

and the division of people into [a] destroyed, wretched [group] and [a] successful, happy [one],

وأوصاف هَؤُلَاءِ وَهَؤُلَاء

and the descriptions of these and those.

وتضمّنت إِثْبَات صِفَات الْكَمَال لله وتنزيهه عَمَّا يضاد كمله من النقائص والعيوب

And it contained the affirmation of the attributes of perfection for God, and declaring Him far above what contradicts His perfection of flaws and defects.

وَذكر فِيهَا القيامتين الصُّغْرَى والكبرى

And He mentioned in it the two risings: the lesser and the greater,

وَالْعَالمِينَ الْأَكْبَر وَهُوَ عَالم الْآخِرَة والأصغر وَهُوَ عَالم الدُّنْيَا

and the two worlds: the greater — which [is] the world of the Hereafter — and the lesser — which [is] this world.

وَذكر فِيهَا خلق الْإِنْسَان ووفاته وإعادته

And He mentioned in it the creation of man, his death, and his return,

وحاله عِنْد وَفَاته وَيَوْم معاده

and his state at his death and [on] the day of his return,

وإحاطته سُبْحَانَهُ بِهِ من كل وَجه حَتَّى علمه بوساوس نَفسه

and His — glorified [is] He — surrounding him from every side, even His knowledge of the whispers of his self,

وَإِقَامَة الْحفظَة عَلَيْهِ يُحصونَ عَلَيْهِ كل لَفْظَة يتَكَلَّم بهَا

and the appointing of guardians over him, recording against him every word he speaks.

وَأَنه يوافيه يَوْم الْقِيَامَة وَمَعَهُ سائق يَسُوقهُ إِلَيْهِ وَشَاهد يشْهد عَلَيْهِ

And that he [will] come on the Day of Resurrection, and with him [is a] driver driving him to Him and [a] witness testifying against him.

فَإِذا أحضرهُ السَّائِق قَالَ

So when the driver brings him, he says:

﴿هَذَا مَا لَدَيَّ عَتِيدٌ﴾

“This [is] what [is] with me, ready.”

[50:23]

أَي هَذَا الَّذِي أمرت بإحضاره قد أحضرته

Meaning: this [is] the one I was commanded to bring — I have brought him.

فَيُقَال عِنْد إِحْضَاره

Then it [is] said upon bringing him:

﴿أَلْقِيَا فِي جَهَنَّمَ كُلَّ كَفَّارٍ عَنِيدٍ﴾

“Throw into Hell every stubborn disbeliever!”

[50:24] Sahih Intl: [Allah will say], «Throw into Hell every obstinate disbeliever —,

كَمَا يحضر الْجَانِي إِلَى حَضْرَة السُّلْطَان فَيُقَال هَذَا فلَان قد أحضرته

Just as [a] criminal [is] brought to the presence of the king, and it [is] said: “This [is] so-and-so, I have brought him,”

فَيَقُول اذْهَبُوا بِهِ إِلَى السجْن وعاقبوه بِمَا يستحقّه

so he says: “Take him to the prison and punish him with what he deserves.”

وتأمّل كَيفَ دلّت السُّورَة صَرِيحًا على أَن الله سُبْحَانَهُ يُعِيد هَذَا الْجَسَد بِعَيْنِه

And reflect [on] how the surah indicated clearly that God — glorified [is] He — [will] return this very body,

الَّذِي أَطَاع وَعصى فينعمه ويعذّبه

the one that obeyed and disobeyed — so He [will] bless it and punish it,

كَمَا ينعم الرّوح الَّتِي آمَنت بِعَينهَا ويعذّب الَّتِي كفرت بِعَينهَا

just as He [will] bless the very soul that believed and punish the very [one] that disbelieved —

لَا أَنه سُبْحَانَهُ يخلق روحا أُخْرَى غير هَذِه فينعمها ويعذبها

not that He — glorified [is] He — [will] create another soul other than this one, then bless it and punish it,

كَمَا قَالَه من لم يعرف الْمعَاد الَّذِي أخْبرت بِهِ الرُّسُل

as said by those who did not know the Return that the messengers informed of,

حَيْثُ زعم أَن الله سُبْحَانَهُ يخلق بدنا غير هَذَا الْبدن من كل وَجه

where he claimed that God — glorified [is] He — [will] create [a] body other than this body in every way,

عَلَيْهِ يَقع النَّعيم وَالْعَذَاب

upon which the bliss and the punishment [will] fall.

وَالروح عِنْده عرض من أَعْرَاض الْبدن

And the soul, according to him, [is] an accident among the accidents of the body,

فيخلق روحا غير هَذِه الرّوح وبدنا غير هَذَا الْبدن

so He [would] create [a] soul other than this soul and [a] body other than this body.

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وَهَذَا غير مَا اتّفقت عَلَيْهِ الرُّسُل ودلّ عَلَيْهِ الْقُرْآن والسنّة وَسَائِر كتب الله تَعَالَى

And this [is] other than what the Messengers agreed upon, and what the Quran, the Sunnah, and the rest of the books of God Most High indicated.

وَهَذَا فِي الْحَقِيقَة إِنْكَار للمعاد وموافقة لقَوْل من أنكرهُ من المكذبين

And this [is] in reality [a] denial of the Return, and [an] agreement with the statement of those who denied it among the deniers.

فَإِنَّهُم لم ينكروا قدرَة الله على خلق أجسام أخر غير هَذِه الْأَجْسَام يعذبها وينعمها

For they did not deny the ability of God to create other bodies besides these bodies, [to] torment them and bless them.

كَيفَ وهم يشْهدُونَ النَّوْع الإنساني يخلق شَيْئا بعد شَيْء

How [could they], when they witness the human species [being] created one after another?

فَكل وَقت يخلق الله سُبْحَانَهُ أجسامًا وأرواحًا غير الْأَجْسَام الَّتِي فنيت

For every moment God, glorified [is] He, creates bodies and souls other than the bodies that perished.

فَكيف يتعجّبون من شَيْء يشاهدونه عيَانًا

So how [can] they be amazed at something they witness with [their own] eyes?

وَإِنَّمَا تعجّبوا من عودهم بأعيانهم بعد أَن مزّقهم البلى وصاروا عظاما ورفاتا

Rather, they were amazed at their return — themselves — after decay tore them apart and they became bones and remains.

فتعجّبوا أَن يَكُونُوا هم بأعيانهم مبعوثين للجزاء

So they were amazed that they — themselves — [would be] raised for recompense.

وَلِهَذَا

And for this [reason],

﴿قَالُوا أئذا مِتْنَا وَكُنَّا تُرَابًا وعظامًا أئنا لمبعوثون﴾

They said, ‘When we [have] died and become dust and bones, will we indeed be raised?’

?Sahih Intl: They said, «When we have died and become dust and bones, are we indeed to be resurrected — [23:82]

وَقَالُوا

And they said,

﴿ذَٰلِكَ رَجْعٌ بعيد﴾

‘That [is a] far-fetched return.’

[50:3]

وَلَو كَانَ الْجَزَاء إِنَّمَا هُوَ لأجسام غير هَذِه لم يكن ذَلِك بعثا وَلَا رجعا بل يكون ابْتِدَاء

And if the recompense were only for bodies other than these, that would not be [a] raising nor [a] return, but rather [it would be a] beginning.

وَلم يكن لقَوْله

And there would not be for His saying —

﴿قَدْ عَلِمْنَا مَا تَنْقُصُ الأَرْض مِنْهُم﴾

‘We already know what the earth takes away from them’

.Sahih Intl: We know what the earth diminishes of them, and with Us is a retaining record — [50:4]

كَبِير معنى

— much meaning.

فَإِنَّهُ سُبْحَانَهُ جعل هَذَا جَوَابا لسؤال مقدّر

For He, glorified [is] He, made this [an] answer to [an] implied question,

وَهُوَ أنّه يُمَيّز تِلْكَ الْأَجْزَاء الَّتِي اخْتلطت بِالْأَرْضِ واستحالت إِلَى العناصر بِحَيْثُ لَا تتميّز

and that [is]: how does He distinguish those parts that mixed with the earth and turned into elements such that they [can] no [longer] be distinguished?

فَأخْبر سُبْحَانَهُ أَنه قد علم مَا تنقصه الأَرْض من لحومهم وعظامهم وأشعارهم

So He, glorified [is] He, informed that He already knows what the earth takes away of their flesh, their bones, and their hair.

وَأَنه كَمَا هُوَ عَالم بِتِلْكَ الْأَجْزَاء فَهُوَ قَادر على تَحْصِيلهَا وَجمعهَا بعد تفرّقها

And that just as He [is] knowing of those parts, He [is] able to obtain them and collect them after their scattering,

وتأليفها خلقا جَدِيدا

and compose them [as a] new creation.

وَهُوَ سُبْحَانَهُ يُقرر الْمعَاد بِذكر كَمَال علمه وَكَمَال قدرته وَكَمَال حكمته

And He, glorified [is] He, establishes the Return by mentioning the completeness of His knowledge, the completeness of His power, and the completeness of His wisdom.

فَإِن شُبه المنكرين لَهُ كلهَا تعود إِلَى ثَلَاثَة أَنْوَاع

For the doubts of the deniers of it all go back to three types.

أَحدهَا اخْتِلَاط أجزائهم بأجزاء الأَرْض على وَجه لَا يتميّز

The first [is] the mixing of their parts with the parts of the earth in [a] way that cannot be distinguished,

وَلَا يحصل مَعهَا تميز شخص عَن شخص

and with which one person cannot be told apart from [another] person.

الثَّانِي أَن الْقُدْرَة لَا تتعلّق بذلك

The second [is] that [divine] power does not extend to that.

الثَّالِث أَن ذَلِك أَمر لَا فَائِدَة فِيهِ

The third [is] that this [is a] matter with no benefit in it,

أَو إِنَّمَا الْحِكْمَة اقْتَضَت دوَام هَذَا النَّوْع الإنساني شَيْئا بعد شَيْء هَكَذَا أبدا

or that wisdom only required the continuation of this human species, one after another, like this forever —

كلما مَاتَ جيل خَلفه جيل آخر

whenever [a] generation died, another generation succeeded it.

فأمّا أَن يُمِيت النَّوْع الإنساني كُله ثمَّ يحيه بعد ذَلِك فَلَا حِكْمَة فِي ذَلِك

As for causing the entire human species to die, then bringing it to life after that — [there is] no wisdom in that.

فَجَاءَت براهين الْمعَاد فِي الْقُرْآن مبنيّة على ثَلَاثَة أُصُول

So the proofs of the Return came in the Quran, built upon three foundations.

أَحدهَا تَقْرِير كَمَال علم الرب سُبْحَانَهُ

The first [is] establishing the completeness of the knowledge of the Lord, glorified [is] He.

كَمَا قَالَ فِي جَوَاب من قَالَ

As He said in answer to the one who said,

﴿مَن يُحيي الْعِظَامَ وَهِيَ رَمِيمٌ﴾

‘Who [will] give life to the bones when they [are] decayed?’

[36:78] Sahih Intl: And he presents for Us an example and forgets his [own] creation. He says, «Who will give life to bones while they are disintegrated?»

﴿قُلْ يُحْيِيهَا الَّذِي أَنْشَأَهَا أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ خَلْقٍ عليم﴾

Say, ‘The One who produced them the first time [will] give them life, and He [is] knowing of every creation.’

[36:79] Sahih Intl: Say, «He will give them life who produced them the first time; and He is, of all creation, Knowing.»

وَقَالَ

And He said,

﴿وَإِنَّ السَّاعَةَ لَآتِيَةٌ فَاصْفَحِ الصَّفْحَ الْجَمِيلَ﴾

‘And indeed the Hour [is] surely coming, so forgive [with a] gracious forgiveness.’

[15:85] Sahih Intl: And We have not created the heavens and earth and that between them except in truth. And indeed, the Hour is coming; so forgive with gracious forgiveness.

﴿إِنَّ رَبَّكَ هُوَ الْخَلَّاقُ الْعَلِيمُ﴾

‘Indeed your Lord — He [is] the All-Creating, the All-Knowing.’

.Sahih Intl: Indeed, your Lord - He is the Knowing Creator — [15:86]

وَقَالَ

And He said,

﴿قَدْ عَلِمْنَا﴾

‘We already know...’

[50:4]

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﴿مَا تَنْقُصُ الْأَرْضُ مِنْهُم﴾

what the earth takes away from them

[50:4]

وَالثَّانِي تَقْرِير كَمَال قدرته كَقَوْلِه

And the second [is] establishing the completeness of His power, as in His saying:

أَو لَيْسَ الَّذِي خلق السَّمَوَات وَالْأَرْضَ بِقَادِرٍ عَلَى أَنْ يَخْلُقَ مِثْلَهُمْ

‘Is not the One who created the heavens and the earth able to create the like of them?’

وَقَوله

and His saying:

﴿بَلَى قَادِرِينَ عَلَى أَنْ نُسَوِّيَ بنانه﴾

Yes, [We are] able to reshape his fingertips

.Sahih Intl: Yes. [We are] Able [even] to proportion his fingertips — [75:4]

وَقَوله ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الْحَقُّ وانه يحي الْمَوْتَى وَأَنَّهُ عَلَى كل شَيْء قدير

and His saying: ‘That [is] because God — He [is] the Truth, and He gives life to the dead, and He [is] over everything capable’

وَيجمع سُبْحَانَهُ بَين الْأَمريْنِ كَمَا فِي قَوْله

And He — glorified [is] He — combines the two matters, as in His saying:

أَو لَيْسَ الَّذِي خلق السَّمَوَات وَالْأَرْضَ بِقَادِرٍ عَلَى أَنْ يَخْلُقَ مِثْلَهُمْ بَلَى وَهُوَ الْخَلاقُ الْعَلِيم

‘Is not the One who created the heavens and the earth able to create the like of them? Yes indeed, and He [is] the Supreme Creator, the All-Knowing’

الثَّالِث كَمَال حكمته كَقَوْلِه

The third [is] the completeness of His wisdom, as in His saying:

وَمَا خَلَقْنَا السَّمَوَات وَالْأَرْض وَمَا بَينهمَا لاعبين

‘And We did not create the heavens and the earth and what [is] between them playing’

وَقَوله

and His saying:

﴿وَمَا خَلَقْنَا السَّمَاء وَالْأَرْض وَمَا بَينهمَا بَاطِلا﴾

And We did not create the sky and the earth and what [is] between them in vain

Sahih Intl: And We did not create the heaven and the earth and that between them aimlessly. That is the assumption of those who disbelieve, so — [38:27] woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire.

وَقَوله

and His saying:

﴿أَيَحْسَبُ الْإِنْسَانُ أَنْ يُتْرَكَ سُدىً﴾

Does man think that he [will] be left without purpose?

Sahih Intl: Does man think that he will be left neglected — [75:36]?

وَقَوله

and His saying:

﴿أَفَحَسِبْتُمْ أَنَّمَا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ عَبَثًا وَأَنَّكُمْ إِلَيْنَا لَا تُرْجَعُونَ﴾

Did you then think that We created you without purpose, and that to Us you [would] not be returned?

Sahih Intl: Then did you think that We created you uselessly and that to Us you would not be returned — [23:115]?»

﴿فَتَعَالَى اللَّهُ الْمَلِكُ الْحق﴾

So exalted [is] God, the King, the Truth

[23:116]

وَقَوله

and His saying:

﴿أَمْ حَسِبَ الَّذِينَ اجْتَرَحُوا السَّيِّئَاتِ أَنْ نَجْعَلَهُمْ كَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ﴾

Or do those who committed evil deeds think that We [will] make them like those who believed and did righteous deeds —

Sahih Intl: Or do those who commit evils think We will make them like those who have believed and done righteous deeds - [make them] equal — [45:21] in their life and their death? Evil is that which they judge.

﴿سَوَاءً مَحْيَاهُمْ وَمَمَاتُهُمْ سَاءَ مَا يَحْكُمُونَ﴾

equal [in] their living and their dying? Evil [is] what they judge!

[45:21]

وَلِهَذَا كَانَ الصَّوَاب أَن الْمعَاد مَعْلُوم بِالْعقلِ مَعَ الشَّرْع

And for this [reason], the correct [view] [is] that the Return [is] known through reason along with revelation

وَأَن كَمَال الرب تَعَالَى وَكَمَال أَسْمَائِهِ وَصِفَاته تَقْتَضِيه وتوجبه

and that the perfection of the Lord, Most High, and the perfection of His names and attributes necessitate it and require it

وَأَنه منزّه عمّا يَقُوله منكروه كَمَا ينزه كَمَاله عَن سَائِر الْعُيُوب والنقائص

and that He [is] far above what its deniers say, just as His perfection [is] far above all flaws and defects

ثمَّ أخبر سُبْحَانَهُ أَن المنكرين لذَلِك لمّا كذّبوا بِالْحَقِّ اخْتَلَط عَلَيْهِم أَمرهم

Then He — glorified [is] He — informed that those who denied that, when they rejected the truth, their affair became confused upon them

﴿فَهُمْ فِي أَمْرٍ مريج﴾

so they [are] in [a] confused affair

[50:5]

مختلط لَا يحصلون مِنْهُ على شَيْء

mixed up — they do not arrive from it at anything

ثمَّ دعاهم إِلَى النّظر فِي الْعَالم الْعلوِي وبنائه وارتفاعه واستوائه وَحسنه والتئامه

Then He called them to look at the upper world — its structure, its height, its evenness, its beauty, and its harmony

ثمَّ إِلَى الْعَالم السفلي وَهُوَ الأَرْض وَكَيف بسطها وهيّأها بالبسط لما يُرَاد مِنْهَا

then to the lower world, which [is] the earth, and how He spread it out and prepared it by [the] spreading for what [is] intended from it

وثبّتها بالجبال وأودع فِيهَا الْمَنَافِع

and He secured it with mountains and placed in it benefits

وَأنْبت فِيهَا من كل صنف حسن من أَصْنَاف النَّبَات

and He grew in it every beautiful kind of [the] types of plants

على اخْتِلَاف أشكاله وألوانه ومقاديره ومنافعه وَصِفَاته

despite the differences of their shapes, colors, sizes, benefits, and qualities

وَأَن ذَلِك تبصرة إِذا تأمّلها العَبْد الْمُنِيب وتبصّر بهَا

and that that [is] an insight — when the servant who turns [to God] reflects on it and gains insight from it

تذكر مَا دلّت عَلَيْهِ مِمَّا أخْبرت بِهِ الرُّسُل من التَّوْحِيد والمعاد

he remembers what it pointed to of what the messengers informed of — monotheism and the Return

فالناظر فِيهَا يتبصّر أَولا ثمَّ يتَذَكَّر ثَانِيًا

So the one looking at it gains insight first, then remembers second

وَأَن هَذَا لَا يحصل إِلَّا لعبد منيب إِلَى الله بِقَلْبِه وجوارحه

and that this does not happen except for [a] servant who turns to God with his heart and his limbs

ثمَّ دعاهم إِلَى التفكّر فِي مَادَّة أَرْزَاقهم وأقواتهم وملابسهم ومراكبهم وجناتهم

Then He called them to reflect on the source of their provisions, their food, their clothing, their mounts, and their gardens

وَهُوَ المَاء الَّذِي أنزلهُ من السَّمَاء وَبَارك فِيهِ

which [is] the water that He sent down from the sky and blessed it

حَتَّى أنبت بِهِ جنّات مُخْتَلفَة الثِّمَار والفواكه

until He grew with it gardens of different fruits and produce

مَا بَين أَبيض وأسود وأحمر وأصفر وحلو وحامض وَبَين ذَلِك

ranging between white and black and red and yellow, and sweet and sour and in between

مَعَ اخْتِلَاف منابعها وتنوع أجناسها وَأنْبت بِهِ

despite the differences of their sources and the variety of their kinds; and He grew with it